

Day 13 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Geography of India: Forest & Wildlife; Agricultural Pattern

READING MATERIAL

Fifth sub-topic of Geography Unit II, combining two adjacent thin clauses. Forest/Wildlife questions favor named facts (Acts, year, counts); Agricultural pattern questions in past papers typically test cropping seasons and regional crop belts.

Q: Real exam: Match these forest types to their description — Tropical Evergreen, Tropical Deciduous, Semi-desert, Mangrove.

A: Tropical Evergreen → Tropical Rain Forest. Tropical Deciduous → Monsoon forest. Semi-desert → Thorny Bushes (scrub vegetation). Mangrove → Tidal Forests (found in coastal/estuarine tidal zones, like the Sundarbans).

Q: When was the Asian cheetah declared extinct in India?

A: 1952.

Q: When was the Indian Wildlife Protection Act implemented?

A: 1972.

Q: What is the Himalayan Yew, and what are 'reserved and protected forests' also called?

A: The Himalayan Yew is a medicinal plant (not an insect, mammal, or bird). Reserved and protected forests together are referred to as the 'permanent forest estate'.

Q: Roughly how many tiger reserves does India have, and what fraction of India's geographical area is 'open forest'?

A: 58 tiger reserves. Open forests cover around 9% of India's total geographical area.

Q: What are the Kharif and Rabi cropping seasons in India?

A: Kharif crops are sown with the onset of the monsoon (June-July) and harvested in autumn (September-October) — e.g. rice, maize, cotton, sugarcane. Rabi crops are sown in winter (October-November) and harvested in spring (March-April) — e.g. wheat, barley, mustard, gram.

Q: What is a third, less prominent cropping season in some parts of India, and what does it grow?

A: Zaid (or Zaikh) — a short summer season between Rabi harvest and Kharif sowing, used for water-intensive or quick-growing crops like watermelon, cucumber, and fodder crops, mainly using irrigation rather than relying on monsoon rains.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Mangrove forests are best classified as:

- A. Tropical Rain Forest
- B. Monsoon forest
- C. Thorny Bushes

D. Tidal Forests ✓

Explanation: Tidal Forests — found in coastal/estuarine tidal zones. [medium, question-bank-2022]

2. Semi-desert vegetation in India is best classified as:

- A. Tropical Rain Forest
- B. Monsoon forest
- C. Thorny Bushes ✓**

D. Tidal Forests

Explanation: Thorny Bushes (scrub vegetation). [medium, question-bank-2022]

3. The Asian cheetah was declared extinct in India in which year?

- A. 1951
- B. 1952 ✓**
- C. 1972
- D. 1975

Explanation: 1952. [medium, web-research]

4. The Indian Wildlife Protection Act was implemented in which year?

- A. 1971
- B. 1972 ✓**
- C. 1982
- D. 2010

Explanation: 1972. [easy, web-research]

5. Reserved and protected forests together are also known as:

- A. Unclassed forest
- B. Permanent forest estate ✓**
- C. Open forest
- D. Mangrove forest

Explanation: Permanent forest estate. [medium, web-research]

6. Which of these crops is a Kharif (monsoon-sown) crop?

- A. Wheat
- B. Mustard
- C. Rice ✓**
- D. Barley

Explanation: Rice is a Kharif crop; the others are Rabi (winter-sown) crops. [easy, authored]

7. Rabi crops are typically harvested in which season?

- A. Autumn (Sept-Oct)
- B. Spring (March-April) ✓**
- C. Monsoon (June-July)
- D. Mid-summer (May)

Explanation: Spring (March-April), after being sown in winter. [easy, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "A Poison Tree" — William Blake

READING MATERIAL

A dark, allegorical poem about the danger of suppressed anger, where unexpressed wrath grows like a tree bearing poisoned fruit. Real coaching-site evidence tests figure-of-speech identification per line, heavily.

Q: What is the poem's plot and central theme?

A: The poet tells his friend about his anger, and the anger ends. But he hides his anger from his enemy instead — and that suppressed wrath grows, like a tended tree, eventually bearing a 'poisonous apple.' His enemy steals into the garden at night, eats the apple, and is found dead under the tree the next morning. Central theme: suppressed anger/enmity is far more dangerous than openly expressed anger — 'enmity dies hard' when concealed rather than resolved.

Q: What is the central, extended metaphor of the poem?

A: Anger is compared to a tree that the poet 'grows' — nurtured with 'fears' (as water) and 'tears' (day and night), eventually bearing a deadly fruit. The poet's relationship to his suppressed wrath is like a gardener's relationship to a plant he deliberately cultivates.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "I was angry with my friend; I told my wrath, my wrath did end."

A: Anaphora — repetition of 'my wrath' across the line for emphasis.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "And I sunned it with smiles, / And with soft deceitful wiles."

A: Alliteration — repeated 's' and 'w' sounds ('sunned'/'smiles'; 'soft'/'deceitful'/'wiles').

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Till it bore an apple bright" and "And I watered it in fears, / Night & morning with my tears."

A: Both are Metaphor — the suppressed anger is directly described as a tree bearing fruit and being watered, without using 'like/as'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "When the night had veiled the pole."

A: Personification — night is given the human-like action of 'veiling' (covering, as with a veil).

Q: What is the rhyme scheme of the poem?

A: AABB — rhyming couplets.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. What happened when the poet told his FRIEND about his anger?

- A. The anger grew worse
- B. The anger ended ✓**
- C. The friend got angry too
- D. Nothing changed

Explanation: Telling his friend, the wrath ended — contrasted with hiding it from his enemy. [easy, web-research]

2. What does the 'poison tree' in the poem represent?

- A. A real tree in the poet's garden
- B. Suppressed/concealed anger ✓**
- C. Friendship
- D. Forgiveness

Explanation: Suppressed anger, nurtured in secret until it becomes deadly. [easy, web-research]

3. What happens to the enemy at the end of the poem?

- A. He apologizes to the poet
- B. He is found dead under the tree, having eaten the poisoned apple ✓**
- C. He destroys the tree
- D. He becomes the poet's friend

Explanation: He sneaks in at night, eats the apple, and is found dead under the tree. [medium, web-research]

4. "I was angry with my friend; I told my wrath, my wrath did end" is an example of:

- A. Alliteration
- B. Anaphora ✓**
- C. Metaphor
- D. Personification

Explanation: Anaphora — repetition of 'my wrath'. [medium, web-research]

5. "Till it bore an apple bright" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Metaphor ✓

C. Hyperbole

D. Personification

Explanation: Metaphor — anger directly described as a fruit-bearing tree. [medium, web-research]

6. "When the night had veiled the pole" uses which figure of speech?

A. Hyperbole

B. Alliteration

C. Personification ✓

D. Metaphor

Explanation: Personification — night given the human action of 'veiling'. [medium, web-research]

7. "A Poison Tree" follows which rhyme scheme?

A. ABAB

B. AABB ✓

C. ABBA

D. No rhyme

Explanation: AABB, rhyming couplets. [medium, web-research]